

Do students' perceptions of their weight reflect their actual BMI percentile?

12,853

STUDENTS ANALYSED
14,041 raw - 1,188 cleaned

GROUPS · EXPLANATORY categorical · 5 levels

PerceptionOfWeight

1	Very underweight	n 207
2	Slightly underweight	n 1,436
3	About the right weight	n 7,351
4	Slightly overweight	n 3,318
5	Very overweight	n 541

RESPONSE VARIABLE

BMIPCT BMI percentile

Quantitative measure, ranges 0–100. Higher = heavier relative to peers.

METHOD

One-way ANOVA

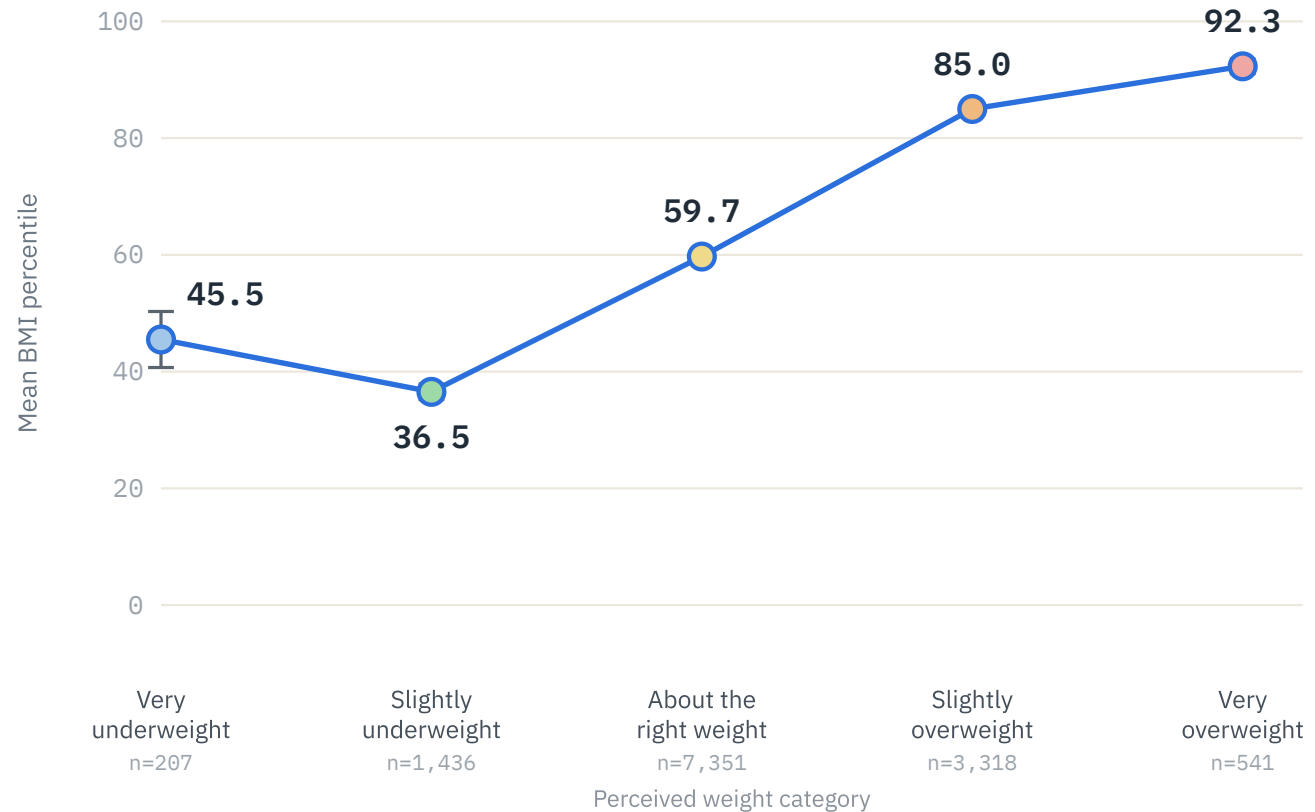
Compares mean BMI percentile across the five perceived-weight groups, then **Tukey HSD** post-hoc for every pair.

H_0 : means equal

$\alpha = .05$

Mean BMI percentile rises steadily with perceived weight

95% CI error bars



KEY RESULT · ANOVA

F = 1,557

$p < 0.0001 \rightarrow$ Reject H_0

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TUKEY PAIRS

Every pairwise comparison is significant ($p < .0001$). Largest gap: Very overweight sits **+55.8 pct** above Slightly underweight.

CONCLUSION

Students' perceived weight is clearly **associated** with their actual BMI percentile – those who feel heavier do have higher percentiles. Because YRBS is observational survey data, this is association, not causation.